



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: John Paul the Great Academy
School Website: <https://jpgacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

John Paul the Great Academy (JPG) in Lafayette, LA presents a robust classical-Catholic framework across its public materials. The school identifies itself as a PK-12 independent Catholic school delivering a rigorous classical curriculum anchored in the Roman Catholic faith, with explicit reference to Trivium and Quadrivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, and a strong emphasis on the family as the "Domestic Church." It integrates liturgical life (Mass and chapel) with academic formation and highlights a governance structure (Board of Trustees, Parent Advisory Committee) that positions parents as active stakeholders and co-educators. This combination—Catholic theology and liturgy, classical curriculum, emphasis on virtue and wisdom, and clear family partnership—aligns with classical-school criteria in multiple dimensions. Evidence drawn from JPG's public materials shows direct statements about Catholic formation, great-books-esque engagement with Western civilization, Trivium/Quadrivium, and a pedagogy that blends memory work, chant, and communal liturgy with rigorous intellectual work.

Overall classification by category (based on keyword analysis and alignment with the Six Essential Elements) tends to be CLASSICAL across four of six categories, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing the strongest signs of CLASSICALNESS but not uniformly explicit in all required pedagogical forms in the public narrative. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: explicit Catholic/trinitarian formation, liturgical life, and the concept of the Domestic Church; formation in truth, faith, and virtue; liturgical rhythm (Mass, chapel) on campus.
 - Positive keyword analysis: clear presence of truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; worship; reverence and wonder; incarnation imagery; "Domestic Church" framing. Based on the Six Elements keyword lexicon, these align with Positive Keywords in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations. Positive keywords present (approx. 12); Negative keywords present (0). Ratio ~ 100% Positive.
 - Why this rating: The school foregrounds Catholic theology, sacramental life, and transcendental ideals as foundational, with explicit phrases about Truth, Faith, Virtue, liturgy, and sacred tradition. This aligns with a Classical-Catholic baseline in this category.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: stated aim of formation and human excellence through a liberal-arts, classical formation; emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and "great conversation" around Western civilization; "Domestic Church" family formation; formation in truth, goodness, beauty.
 - Positive keyword analysis: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, liberal education, great conversation, universals (truth/goodness/beauty), and human flourishing appear in school materials and align with Positive Keyword indicators in the category. Positive keywords present (approx. 9); Negative keywords present (0). Ratio ~ 100% Positive.
 - Why this rating: JPG frames education as formation for virtue and wisdom, not mere job prep,

and explicitly references the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty in its mission and curriculum framing.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: explicit reference to Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books/Great Conversation, study of Western Civilization, Latin/Greek roots, historical integration, and a curriculum anchored in the Trivium/Quadrivium.
- Positive keyword analysis: Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books / Great Conversation; history as Western Civilization; Latin/Greek roots; interdisciplinary approach; integration and wonder; track of Western civilization; and the classical pedagogy emphasis. Positive keywords present (approx. 8–10); Negative keywords present (0). Ratio ~ 100% Positive.
- Why this rating: The materials consistently articulate a classical curriculum architecture (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Western civilization, integration). This is a core hallmark of classical education.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Lower School emphasizes memory (poetry memorization), phonics, Greek/Latin roots, music; pedagogy hints at contemplative aims (Scholé-like framing in classical sources) and memory-driven recitation. There is less explicit public evidence of upper-school Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric pedagogy in JPG's public materials, though "classical education" framing and the Great-Books-text orientation imply some Socratic/seminar-like aims in a broader sense.
- Positive keyword analysis: memory work, recitation, poetry, music, classical pedagogy, Trivium emphasis, Great Books framing. Positive keywords present (approx. 4–6); Negative keywords present (0 or minimal). Ratio ~ Very high Positive, but explicit high-level Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not consistently documented in public-facing pages.
- Why this rating: While JPG clearly centers a classical pedagogy via memory work and linguistic/-musical training, explicit upper-school Socratic seminars, debates, and formal rhetoric training are not consistently evidenced in the public materials. This leads to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than a full CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. The absence of explicit, widely-cited Socratic seminars or heavy seminar-based pedagogy in the public materials is the distinguishing factor.

- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: public materials describe faculty as role models and master teachers; statements about faculty shaping the school's living curriculum; Board leadership emphasizes Catholic fidelity and professional leadership; Head of School and faculty leadership are highlighted.
- Positive keyword analysis: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; master teachers; collegial culture; faculty as central to formation. Positive keywords present (approx. 6–8); Negative keywords present (0). Ratio ~ 100% Positive.
- Why this rating: JPG presents a strong faculty emphasis aligned with classical ideals (teachers as virtuous exemplars, living curriculum, and parental governance structures). This aligns closely with classical-faculty indicators.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Domestic Church framing (family as central to education); explicit partnership with families; Parent Advisory Committee; open-campus/parent involvement; a governance structure that includes parent input and a family-centric mission.
- Positive keyword analysis: partnership with families; co-educators; parental formation; open campus; family-centered learning; parent involvement; community support. Positive keywords present (approx. 6–8); Negative keywords present (0). Ratio ~ 100% Positive.
- Why this rating: The school emphasizes parent partnership, family formation, and parental involvement as core features, which aligns with classical-community expectations.

Aggregate assessment: Based on the six categories, JPG demonstrates strong alignment with Classical education principles across almost all categories, with Element 4 showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL due to less explicit public documentation of Socratic/seminal pedagogy at the upper levels. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 4 (Pedagogy) — move toward CLASSICAL in a more explicit, documented way:
 - Publish explicit references to upper-school Socratic seminars, seminars, debates, and formal rhetoric training (e.g., declared curricula or program pages showing Socratic method in action and sample seminar prompts).
 - Add language about scholé days or contemplative/restful instructional blocks in more detail, including concrete examples of memory work, recitation programs, and chanting or liturgical-integrated pedagogy beyond lower grades.
 - Include explicit statements about how upper- and middle-school students engage in great books discussions and dialectic as part of a structured pedagogy, with examples of memory work or oratory tasks tied to Great Books.
 - Provide a public-facing outline or PDF of Pedagogy plans for grades 9–12 that show clear Socratic-discussion and rhetoric-track components, with assessment approaches.
- No major needle-moving steps required for Categories 1–3, 5–6 since they already exhibit strong CLASSICAL traits (Catholic metaphysical foundations, formation-focused purpose, liberal-arts curriculum, living/faculty-centered approach, and robust parent/community partnerships). A few additional explicit elements could further strengthen the Pedagogy narrative, but the core CLASSICAL alignment is already present.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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